Do you have other social media?	*List any of the virtual community to which you are a member?*	*Your Language/s*_____

- Discuss over the following Ethiopian Proverbs
    - *Diversity is spice of life.*
    - *Claw my back, and I will claw yours.*
    - *Company in distress makes trouble less.*

11.1. Understanding cultural Diversity

Brainstorming Questions

- ***Can you define diversity?***
- ***What is the importance of cultural diversity to live together in harmony?***

Diversity has become the defining characteristic of our social and cultural worlds. We are now constantly confronted with a multitude of ways in which we can define ourselves, and categorize others. Ethnicity, nationality, gender, religion, occupation, political affiliation, skin color, profession, and others can define our identity. Our social and cultural worlds are increasingly unassailably and multifaceted. For instance, Ethiopian population is made up varieties of peoples, languages, religions, cultures, political orientations, and many more. No one can define himself/herself exclusively. We no longer live in the provincial, homogenized worlds that characterized much of human history in the world. We live in worlds defined by diversity.

Culture is the criteria with which we evaluate everything around us. We evaluate what is proper or improper, normal or abnormal through our culture. If we are immersed in a culture that is unlike with that of ours, we may experience culture shock and become disoriented. When we come into contact with a fundamentally different culture, we start thinking about our culture.. People naturally use their culture as the standard to judge other cultures. However, passing judgment could reach a level where people begin to discriminate against others whose “ways of being” are different from their own. Essentially, we tend to fear the culture we do not understand.

Cultural diversity helps us recognize and respect “ways of being” that are not necessarily ours. If we interact with others, we can build bridges to trust, respect, and understanding

across cultures. Furthermore, this diversity makes our country a more interesting place to live. People from diverse cultures contribute language skills, new ways of thinking, new knowledge, and different experiences. Moreover, cultural diversity is important because our country, workplaces, and schools increasingly consist of various cultural, religious, and ethnic groups. We can learn from one another but first we must have a level of understanding about each other in order to facilitate collaboration and cooperation. Learning about other cultures helps us understand different perspectives within the world in which we live, and helps dispel negative stereotypes and personal biases about different groups.

The term "culturally diverse" is often used interchangeably with the concept of "multiculturalism." Multiculturalism is defined as: "*…a system of beliefs and behaviors that* recognizes and respects *the presence of all diverse groups in an organization or society,* acknowledges and values *their socio cultural differences, and* encourages *and enables their continued contribution within an inclusive cultural context which* empowers *all within the organization or society (Belfield, 2012).*

Reflection

- ***How do you appreciate cultural diversity? Discuss over the advantages and disadvantages?***

Diversity Management

Brainstorming Question

- ***How should we live with our friends/work colleagues from a different culture?***

The key to manage diversity is to capitalize more effectively on our capacity for multiple social identities. All individuals have multicultural heritage, and all of us are capable of juggling multiple identities across a lifetime (Seelye & Wasilewski, 1996). Hence, to manage cultural diversities and live with others in harmony, we need to;

- Increase level of understanding about each other's cultures by interacting with people outside of one's own culture
- Avoid imposing values on one other that may conflict or be inconsistent with cultures.
- When interacting with others who may not be proficient in one's language, recognize that their limitations in the language proficiency in no way reflects their level of intellectual functioning.

- Recognize and understand that concepts within the helping profession, such as family, gender roles, spirituality, and emotional well-being, vary significantly among cultures and influence behavior.
- Within the workplace, educational setting, and/or clinical setting, advocate for the use of materials that are representative of the various cultural groups within the local community and the society in general.
- Intervene in an appropriate manner when you observe others engaging in behaviors that show cultural insensitivity, bias, or prejudice.
- Being proactive in listening, accepting, and welcoming people and ideas that are different from your own

Reflection

- ***What is the importance of diversity in teaching learning process? Discuss the pros and cons of diversity.***

11.2. Gender and Social Inclusion

Brainstorming Questions

- ***What is the difference between sex and gender?***
- ***Describe the roles of women in your society.***
- ***Do you think women and men have equal rights and responsibilities in your society?***

The term "sex" usually refers to biological phenomena such as hormones and reproduction. However, gender is an organizing principle of all social systems, including families, work, schools, economic and legal systems, and everyday interactions. Scholarship conceptualizing gender as an institution encompasses three levels of analysis: individual, interactional, and structural (e.g., Risman, 1998). The individual level refers to stable traits of men and women that endure over time in the process of human life span development, such as differences believed to be rooted in biology or early childhood socialization. The interactional level examines the ways in which social behavior is constrained or facilitated by expectations that people have regarding the traits men and women possess, the ways they should act, and the beliefs they should hold. The structural level addresses how macro level patterns, such as the positions to which people are assigned in society or the rewards attached to those positions, lead to differences in the behavior or experiences of men and women.

Excluding or limiting women's roles and benefits in social, political and economic arena is a part of human history. Development activities of a given nation mainly emerged from the cultural orientation of that nations have been denying women benefits that they should have got despite their significant contribution for the development. Hence, nations, right groups, nation leaders and scholars have been demanding more rights for women and inclusion of developmental activities. Therefore, women should benefit from education, economy, leadership system, development programs and legal system. Build a culture of gender inclusion across implementing the following is important.

- Encourage inclusive engagement in all areas of development and cross-cutting initiatives;
- Apply gender-inclusive approaches of development
- Promote good practices in gender inclusion; and
- Optimize resources and prosperity for all

Reflection

- ***List and discuss the differences and similarities of men and women?***
- ***How do you compare the live of women in urban and rural parts of Ethiopia?***

11.3. Interpersonal Communication Skills

Brainstorming Questions

- ***Have you ever analyzed your relationship with your friend?***
- ***Do you have some kinds of skills to live with your friends?***

Interpersonal communication is not just about what is actually said, the language used but also how it is said and the non-verbal messages sent through tone of voice, facial expressions, gestures and body language. Core areas in which competency are essential for effective interpersonal interactions include the following: Self-awareness, effective listening, questioning, oral communication, helping or facilitating, reflecting, assertiveness and non-verbal communications **(**Facial expressions, gaze, gestures, posture, paralinguistic cues).

Interpersonal communication is the process by which people exchange information, feelings, and meaning through verbal and non-verbal messages. It is face-to-face communication.
Interpersonal skills can be defined broadly as "those skills which one needs in order to communicate

effectively with another person or a group of people

Reflection

- ***What are similarities and differences between interpersonal relationship and interpersonal communication (reading assignment)***
- ***What are the core areas in which competency are essential for effective interpersonal interactions? Discuss in detail (reading assignment)***

11.4. Social Influences

Brainstorming Questions

- ***How do you respond if someone orders you to stop?***

By definition, social influence occurs when one person (the source) engages in some behavior (such as persuading, threatening, promising, or issuing orders) that causes another person (the target) to behave differently from how he or she would otherwise behave. Various outcomes can result when social influence is attempted. In some cases, the influencing source may produce attitude change - a change in the target's beliefs and attitudes about some issue, person, or situation. Attitude change is a fairly common result of social influence. In other cases, however, the source may not really care about changing the target's attitudes but only about securing compliance. Compliance occurs when the target's behavior conforms to the source's requests or demands.

Reflection

- ***How do you react to an order from your family members, friends, teachers, police officers and other ordinary individuals?***
- ***What are the differences among compliance, conformity and obedience (Reading assignment)***

11.5. Peer Pressure

Brainstorming Questions

- ***How do you explain the following proverbs?***

  "Birds of the same fly together"?

  "Tell me your friends, I will tell you who you are"

Peer pressure is the influence to go along with the beliefs and actions of one's peers. Peer pressure may be positive when it inspires a person to do something worthwhile. The desire to fit in and feel like you are part of a group is normal, and most people feel this way